Daniel Okafor-Reyes

Backend Engineer | Java, Kotlin, Spring Boot

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 6+ years of professional experience building and maintaining backend services in Java and Kotlin. Experienced in designing REST APIs, working with PostgreSQL and Kafka, writing automated tests, and operating services in production. Uses AWS services including EKS, S3 and SQS, and Docker. Targeting a primarily Python backend role, bringing 6+ years of backend experience in Java and Kotlin; Python experience to date is limited to scripts and small Jenkins helpers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Kotlin; Python (scripts and small Jenkins helpers); Go (learning; personal CLI project)
Backend and APIs: Spring Boot, REST APIs, OpenAPI 3, microservices
Data and messaging: PostgreSQL, Oracle, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Redis, AWS SQS
Testing: Testcontainers, Spring Cloud Contract
Cloud and deployment: AWS (EKS, S3, SQS) — service-user experience; Kubernetes; Docker
Other: On-call operations, API versioning, rate limiting, idempotency, transactional outbox

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer | Tejo Insurance Tech *2022–Present*

- Build and maintain Java and Kotlin Spring Boot microservices, including services using Kafka and PostgreSQL.
- Designed a versioned OpenAPI 3 REST API for insurance brokers; introduced per-partner rate limiting and contract tests with Spring Cloud Contract. The API supports 12 broker partners and around 400,000 quote requests per month.
- Resolved duplicate claim records caused by at-least-once Kafka delivery by implementing a transactional outbox and idempotency keys for consumers. Duplicate claims fell from around 40 per week to zero over the following quarter.
- Built the company's first Kotlin service, an internal policy-document service that renders PDFs from templates, and wrote the team's Kotlin coding guidelines.
- Participate in the on-call rota, one week per month. Handled a major Kafka lag incident in March 2024; the incident write-up was praised.
- Use AWS S3 and SQS as a service user; read Terraform but have not written Terraform modules.
- Run the backend guild meeting every two weeks (since 2024).

Software Developer | Viajar Online *2019–2021*

- Worked on the booking and payments areas of a large Java application.
- Raised payments-module test coverage from 35% to 70% using Testcontainers, enabling safer refactoring.
- Extracted email and SMS notifications from the booking monolith into a separate Spring Boot service, using RabbitMQ for messaging, Thymeleaf for templates, and Docker.

SELECTED PROJECT

OpenAPI Specification Diff CLI | Personal project *In progress*

- Building a Go command-line tool to compare OpenAPI specifications. Approximately 600 lines; a learning project, not a production service.

CERTIFICATION

Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 11 Developer | 2020

LANGUAGES

English: Used as the working language at Tejo Insurance Tech